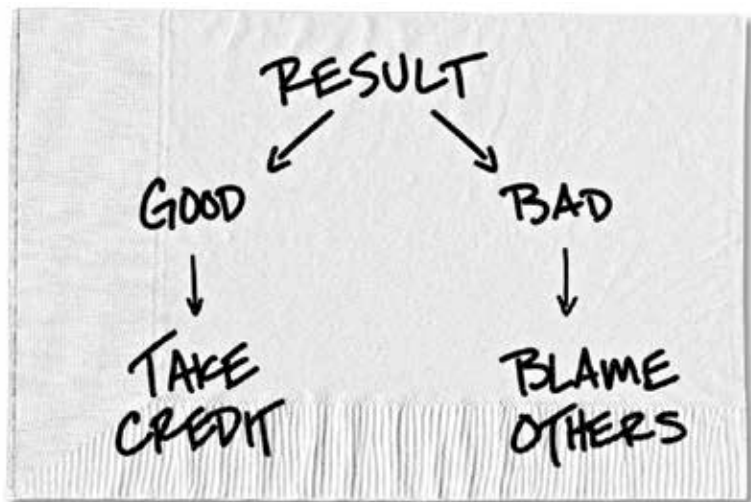


with, reinforcing our confirmation bias and pushing us deeper into these echo chambers of political polarisation.

Confirmation bias can be particularly destructive in some situations, such as the legal system. A detective might, for example, identify a suspect early in an inquiry and then look for corroborating evidence while down-playing fabricating evidence.



Haven't we all experienced this?

Self-Serving Bias

The tendency to assume personal credit for favourable outcomes while blaming external sources for negative ones is known as self-serving bias.

You're correct to wonder how this compares to the fundamental attribution error, which describes our inclination to attribute external variables to other people's conduct while emphasising internal factors for our own.

The self-serving bias differs in that it is concerned with valence. That is, how good or horrible a situation or occurrence is. It also only applies to events in which you are a participant.

In other words, if a driver cuts you off as the light turns green, the fundamental attribution error may lead you to believe they are a nasty person and ignore the likelihood that they were late for work.

When you're the actor, on the other hand, you'll use the self-serving bias. In this scenario, you would be the motorist who cuts in front of the